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At Avtar Foundation for the Arts in MRC Nagar, the shortlisted works of CPB International Open Call - Edition 2 are being exhibited



Images by Deepak Kumbhar and (above) Ranita Roy



Chennai Photo Biennale (CPB) Foundation is back with its second edition of its international open call showcase. Selected work reviewed by an esteemed international jury panel is being presented as two public exhibitions opening on March 15; 12 p.m. at VR Chennai; and March 19; 5 p.m. at Avtar Foundation for the Arts, MRC Nagar. The exhibitions are free and open to all and will remain open till April 5, 2026.

Over 9,400 photographs submitted across single image and photo stories categories were received for this edition from participants representing 37 countries. Over 100 photographers are selected for the showcase, said a release.

The CPB International Photography Open Call is an opportunity for photographers and visual artists

working with the medium of photography to present their creative vision and talent to public audiences in Chennai.

Open to photographers and artists of any age from anywhere in the world, photographic work from any niche can be submitted to the open call that is reviewed by an international jury of curators, artists, and editors, providing participants with unparalleled visibility and global exposure. An open theme allows for work ranging from nature, portraits, documentary, still life, landscape photography and more to be submitted to the open call. Submissions are restricted to photographic or lens-based work, but can include combinations with other art forms such as performance, painting, audio, sculpture, literature and text, added the release.

Fundraiser event to support a charitable home

‘Birds of Border’, a theatrical production by Ekatha, will be staged at Museum Theatre on March 21 and 22 to raise funds for Shanthi Bhavan

Shanthi Bhavan, a charitable home providing free residential care to aged destitute, is having a fundraiser to raise money to upgrade its current facility at Sholavaram.

‘Birds of Border’, a theatrical production by Ekatha, will be staged at Museum Theatre on March 21 and 22.

The play is a moving and thought-provoking performance that explores themes of love, compassion, emotional resilience, and the breaking of human boundaries.

Shanthi Bhavan currently supports 50 elderly residents, many of whom were referred by hospitals, police and

local authorities. They are given free accommodation, meals, medical care and emotional support. Under ‘Mission 100’ it plans to expand the capacity of the Bhavan to accommodate 100 residents. The project seeks CSR support from corporate partners and philanthropists to build new residential facilities, strengthen health and emergency support, and implement green, cost-saving solutions such as solar power, biogas and eco-friendly sanitation, said a release.

For details, call 9005008736 / 9789376357; Website: www.shanthibhavan.org

Free art workshop in Alwarpet

Kalaa Manjari Creativity Center - Global Art in Alwarpet is conducting a free art workshop for children aged 5 years and above.

The session will give young participants a chance to explore colours and creativity and enjoy fun learn-

ing, said a release.

The centre is located at 25/13, Second Street, East Abhiramapuram (behind Nageshwara Rao Park), Alwarpet.

Parents can register for the workshop by calling 91766 10660 or via WhatsApp. Email: kalaamanjari@gmail.com

Free computer classes in Mylapore and T. Nagar

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan’s Gandhi Institute of Computer Education and Information Technology Centre offers free computer education to unemployed youth belonging to the economically backward sections of society.

Students are trained in various job oriented computer courses like MS-Office, Tally and DTP. These courses have helped many students to secure employment at various levels, said a release. Senior citizens can enrol for Microsoft Word, Excel and Internet classes. Last date for collection and submission of filled in application forms is March 28. For details contact in person. The centre is at East Mada Street, Mylapore; call 24611312, 24643420) and at sub-centre at Thanikachalam Road, T.Nagar.

Green roofs are back



Greater Chennai Corporation has started installing shelters at key junctions to shield motorists from the sun this summer. This one is at Spencer Plaza junction. PHOTO: RAGU R

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A WALLET WITH 'EYES'

National Association for the Blind — Tamil Nadu has launched an initiative to distribute Vision Wallets to visually impaired individuals **P3**



STITCHING LIVES

Rotary Club of Chennai Legends hands over motorised sewing machines to women to start their own enterprises **P5**

Visitors from Scotland at P. Orr & Sons



March 3, 2026 will go down as an eventful day for the 176-year-old P. Orr and Sons.

According to a press release, Andrew Orr, the great great grandson of Peter Orr, founder of P. Orr & Sons visited the Anna Salai Showroom and spent quality time with employees of the establishment. He also interacted with long-term customers, sharing his experience of his earlier visits.

A medical practitioner in Scotland, Andrew said it was his tenth visit to India. He mentioned that he was actively engaged in writing the history of P. Orr & Sons to bring out a book. Andrew Orr and his wife

Antonia Orr were greeted by longest-serving employees of the establishment. The couple had long chat with Brand representatives to understand the current trend of watch business.

Valli Ramaswamy, the chairperson P. Orr & Sons, recalled her family's long association with ORR family.

Set in Byzantine and Indo-Saracenic architecture, the establishment's building at Anna Salai had been built by British architect Robert Chriholm. Besides the flagship Annasalai showroom, P. Orr & Sons has eight showrooms including those in Trichy, Coimbatore & Pudukcherry.

'Warning against flying kites near railway areas'

Kite flying is kept on a tight string, due to bans; but it still persists in some pockets of the city which include Royapuram and adjacent areas; hence this advisory is valuable

The Chennai Division of Southern Railway has issued a public advisory to avoid flying kites in and around railway tracks, stations, overhead electric lines (OHE), and other railway premises. Flying kites near railway infrastructure creates safety hazards.

Kite strings, particularly those coated with metallic or synthetic materials (*manja* in Tamil), can get entangled in OHE lines carrying 25,000 volts, a release from the railway stated. This may lead to severe electric shock, fatal accidents, and disruptions to train services.

Legal provisions

Flying kites in railway areas is a punishable offence under the provisions of the Railways Act, 1989, particularly under Sections 147 (trespass), 150 (unlawful entry into railway premises), 150 (malicious acts endangering the safety of persons travelling by railway), and 151 (damage to railway property).



Representational picture only.

The violators are liable to a monetary fine of up to ₹ 1000 and imprisonment of up to six months as per the Railways Act, 1989. Parents and guardians are urged to advise children about the dangers and ensure they do not play or fly kites near railway tracks or stations, the release added.

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Will sustainable cooking gain a toehold?

As shortage in supply of LPG affects commercial kitchens, an enterprise working in that space with units in R.A. Puram and Semmancherry and a business promoting sale of traditional cookware with outlets at ECR and R.A. Puram weigh in on this question

PRINCE FREDERICK

Solutions that are sustainable in the long run and dependable in all seasons but requiring modifications in processes and behaviours in the short term will be ignored as long as solutions, easier but unreliable in some situations and even harmful in some others, are readily on tap. When that free-flowing tap suddenly settles to a trickle, sustainable solutions might get a toehold.

Currently, sustainable cooking solutions are gaining a toehold in commercial kitchens. Between jittery fingers, they are twirling various options that can do without the LPG cylinder. Some of these kitchens might be taking time out, but backstage they could be exploring sustainable cooking options.

The Semmancherry unit of Dabbakaran recently put out a note for its “Dear Dabbakaran Family” that “due to the ongoing crisis in commercial LPG cylinder supply, we are unable to source new cylinders. We deeply regret to inform you that we will not be able to supply food from 12th March, 2026 until this issue is resolved.

We are looking out for other alternative options to resolve the issue. We assure you that we will resume our services as early as possible.”

What pops out at any reader of this communication (it should, if it does not) is “other al-



Wood-fired mud stove in a pastoral setting in India. Sleek and fancy wood-fired stoves are also being offered as an option in modern domestic kitchen systems. Will commercial kitchens now adopt this form of sustainability at scale? GETTY IMAGES

ternative options”.

When *The Hindu Downtown* got in touch with a team member of Dabbakaran, it is obvious that behind the temporarily lowered shutters of its Semmancherry unit, the business which caters meals for subscribers is not leaving any stone (actually, ‘any wood’ or ‘food waste’) unturned in cranking up the services quickly and preventing a stretched lull.

The team member observes they are considering the option of cooking with wood, minimal wood, on a blower-assisted stove.

The team member pulls out another option that is under study: zero-waste cooking. Turning food waste into gas, popularly known as biogas.

The Semmancherry unit caters for 500 members, many of whom are in the sixty-plus age bracket, and depend heavily on this service (breakfast, lunch and dinner), hence the desperate attempts to kickstart it with alternative cooking methods, says the team member. Dabbakaran continues to run its kitchen in R.A. Puram with a trimmed-down menu; this kitchen serves around 900 meals (lunch and dinner) every day.

Traditional cookware in focus

Kayal Sriram runs an eponymous enterprise, Essential Traditions by Kayal, that sells traditional iron, cast-iron, soapstone and brass cookware and serveware from two physical outlets, one on ECR and the other at R.A. Puram,

and online. Domestic kitchens have constituted the business’s strong base; but the current crisis seems bent on extending the business into the commercial kitchen, as the movement in that direction has already happened, precisely one month before this crisis showed up on the horizon.

Kayal notes the foray one month ago into serving commercial kitchens had to do with “serving”, that is sale of serveware. Now, following the events of the last few days, the focus has widened to include cookware.

Kayal points out that the efforts would be directed towards scaling traditional cookware, making them more capacious: large-sized cookware. Among the traditional cookware that are

likely to gain traction after the recent turn of events, Kayal names wood-fired stoves, because they are already leaving their “flavour” behind in modern kitchens. She explains that modern kitchens are incorporating wood-fired stoves as an option.

She is also witnessing an interest in *kumuti adupu* (charcoal stoves) as a result of the LPG crisis. While she has no problem with these being used in domestic settings, she

considers huge charcoal stoves infeasible, even inadvisable (given their capacity for pollution when used at scale) in commercial kitchens. In certain parts of the country, particularly the NCR region, a ban on the use of these stoves in commercial kitchens are firmly in place.

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

Anyone with normal vision would need just a quarter of a glance to distinguish a ₹50 note from a ₹500 note. For a visually impaired individual, any effort in that direction would require dependence on others. The Tamil Nadu state branch of National Association for the Blind (NAB) is seeking to cut out that dependence by distributing “Vision Wallets” to visually impaired individuals. On March 13, at its office in Kodungaiyur, it distributed these Vision Wallets to 15 visually impaired women, to mark International Women’s Day. The 15 are part of a batch of 250 visually impaired individuals across Tamil Nadu to receive this assistive device. The Vision Wallets are sponsored by Synamedia India Pvt. Ltd., Tharamani; Reachem Laboratory Chemicals Pvt. Ltd.; and the Rotaract Clubs. Applications would open after this batch of 250 are served.

What is a Vision Wallet anyway? Developed by H Vision India Pvt. Ltd., the device allows users to instantly identify currency denominations and detect counterfeit notes without relying on a smartphone or internet connectivity. It resembles a conventional men’s wallet fitted with a compact electronic module. Embedded sensors detect the currency note and relay the denomination through audio output in Hindi and English. Specially designed grooves guide the note into position from any corner, enabling the sensors to read it accurately and announce the value almost instantly without internet connectivity. The device came to NAB’s attention after one of the organisation’s secretaries encountered it at an assistive technology exhibition organised by Vellore Institute of Technology. Dipti Bhatia, CEO of NAB’s Tamil Nadu branch, says it was obvious to them that it offered a practical solution. “Many people think visually impaired persons can simply use smartphones or Google Pay,” she observes. “But not everyone owns a smartphone or is comfortable using one. Even existing apps require scanning and waiting, and sometimes the voice output is too soft or the scan fails. The wallet offers a simple and quick hands-on solution.”

The priority list

The organisation received more than 250 applications from across the State. However, limited funding meant only a small number of wallets could be distributed in the first phase. Beneficiaries were selected based on income: those earning less than ₹2 lakh annually received the device free of cost;



A wallet with ‘eyes’

National Association for the Blind — Tamil Nadu has launched an initiative to distribute Vision Wallets to visually impaired individuals with an event organised at its office in Chennai on March 13. The assistive device spells out the denomination of a currency note



Snapshots of the event at NAB’s Chennai office; and the Vision Wallet. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

A word from the beneficiaries

Mary from Pallikaranai earns her livelihood through chair re-caning. Running a business is tough, doing so as a visually challenged person, tougher still. The initiative by the Tamil Nadu branch of the National Association for the Blind (NAB), has taken one worry off her table. “Now I can confidently say that I am

giving the correct amount without worrying about being cheated,” says Mary.

Another beneficiary, Krithika, a first-year student of Madras Christian College, says this Vision Wallet would put an end to a dependence while shopping: “asking the person next to me about the denomination of the currency I was giving”.

those earning between ₹2 lakh and ₹5 lakh paid a nominal contribution of ₹500; and those earning above ₹5 lakh are expected to purchase it independently. The device carries an approximate market price of ₹3,600. Priority was also given to students and individuals who frequently handle cash such as street vendors, small traders and others whose livelihoods depend on regular cash transactions.

The initiative was spearheaded by Vikas, honorary secretary of the NAB Tamil Nadu branch. After testing it, he recognised its practicality immediately. “When I placed currency notes on the device, I found it to be very useful and practical,” he said. The initiative also hit an early setback when an NGO that had initially planned to supply the wallets withdrew from the programme, by which point hundreds had already applied. “We felt we could not abandon them because the wallet could significantly improve their independence,” said Vikas. The organisation turned to donors and supporters to sustain the project.

The origin story

The Vision Wallet itself originated from a moment of observation. In 2019, while pursuing product design, founder of H Vision India Pvt. Ltd., Hasin Vaidya visited the Blind People’s Association in Ahmedabad and noticed a visually impaired man struggling to identify a ₹10 note after buying tea. “To make a payment of ten rupees, the person took around four to five minutes,” he recalled. “Even after giving the note, he asked the tea seller to confirm if it was a ₹10 note.” That moment led Hasin to rethink the wallet entirely. “I thought of making the wallet itself smart,” he said. “In the same wallet where they keep their currency notes and documents, they should also be able to identify the notes.” User feedback shaped several improvements. Battery life extended from 1.5 days to two days to nearly a month, with only an hour of charging required. The automatic power feature was replaced with a manual on-off switch, allowing users to activate the device only when needed. Some users asked for coin identification but it was not implemented because it was technically impractical. After years of development, the company launched its first production batch in 2024 and began collaborating with NGOs across India. Users who can afford the device can buy it directly online from the manufacturer, at hvision.in. NAB welcomes donors to support their initiative to distribute the device to visually impaired individuals. Donors can sponsor the cost of three or five wallets. NAB can be contacted at 9840917314.

Young voices for organ donation

Through 'Angels of Change', Chennai-based Mohan Foundation is raising youngsters to serve as advocates for organ donation



LIFFY THOMAS

When a biology lesson on organ systems generated immense interest among Class VIII students of The Pupil International School, the biology teacher Mathura saw an opportunity for an extended class, one about organ donation helmed by subject matter experts from Mohan Foundation. The session eventually led to the formation of Organ Donation Awareness Club led by 25 Class VIII students.

In February, the Club conducted an awareness campaign at the school with a skit and a song, thoughtfully executed by the students to engage their peers. A short film *Second Beat* with students, parents and teachers as actors sends out a powerful message on grief, hope and courage inherent in the process of organ donation.

As an extension of Club's activities, students are reaching out to the communities around them. In a rangoli competition at her gated community in Iyyappanthangal, Aadhira K. drew a design to draw residents' attention to organ donation. Her classmates Deepthi T. has met 15 residents at her gated community in Porur to throw light on organ donation. And Shivam S. along with a group is getting a skit on the topic ready to present it at a city college.

Mohan Foundation, a Chennai-based non-profit promoting organ donation, transplantation and public awareness started 'Angels of Change' before the pandemic to encourage young voices to become advocates for the cause. Over the last two years, this programme has been customised for school students, and it travels across the country.

Before the pandemic, students of Punjab Association Group of Schools in Chennai signed up for the 'Angels of Change' programme. Two schools from Delhi have initiated this programme for their highschoolers. Likewise, Mumbai also has schools that are showing interest in running this programme as a club activity.

Hemal Kanvinde, Quality Assurance Officer, Mohan Foundation, says some students sign up as individuals, either taking it up during their summer or winter break or as an internship.

A student volunteer from Dubai (now pursuing her MBBS), who completed the programme, went on to receive The Diana Award.

"The motivation to sign up for this programme is different, some are drawn by an incident in the family, some to engage in a meaningful act of service as part of their curriculum and many out of curiosity," says Hemal.

"We support them 2-3 times before we let them do activities on their own," says Hemal, inviting more schools to be part of the



Aadhira K from Iyyappanthangal drew this rangoli at a competition in her gated community to raise awareness about organ donation; and (above) the batch performs a skit.

programme.

The Foundation also runs an Ambassador programme, which is open to students and adults.

Legacy club

The Foundation is also working on putting Angels of Change as a

legacy club in school, so that the initiative gets passed on from one batch to another.

Dr. Saveetha, director, The Pupil International School, says the idea to start an organ donation awareness club came from the students and we want them to

The programme

The Angels of Change programme has three modules. The first one is an online programme, which essentially functions as a primer on organ donation. The three-to-four-hour course also covers FAQs that children can prepare themselves for while talking to others.

The second part is conducted in person and involves meeting a recipient, donor and talking to experts, an example being a grief counsellor. The last part deals with ways to engage in positive conversations and the right vocabulary that must be used. For example, saying "organs were harvested" is not saying it in an acceptable manner.

Following the completion of the course, participants get a kit comprising IEC materials, donor card and flyer. The participants are expected to conduct two public awareness talks or campaigns such as a poster competition, debate, awareness talk in their parents circle, done under the guidance of Mohan Foundation staff as part of the completion of the training.

For details, write to info@mohanfoundation.org

handhold their juniors to carry forward the activities they began. We are working out a plan to see how the regular activities can be conducted from the coming academic year.

Stitching lives

Rotary Club of Chennai Legends hands over motorised sewing machines to women to start their own enterprises

Rotary Club of Chennai Legends, in association with Rotary International District 3234, organised Rotosew, a programme to donate 225 motorised sewing machines to women from economically disadvantaged backgrounds in the city. The event, held to mark International Women's Day, was aimed at supporting them in starting their own tailoring ventures.

Prior to the distribution of the sewing machines, Rotary Club of Chennai Legends conducted a two-month vocational training programme for the beneficiaries in stitching garments for women, men and children at its Rotary Skill Development Centre located at Dr. MGR Janaki College of Arts and Science for Women.

Rotary Club of Chennai Legends plans to make the programme an annual feature. The club is also



seeking Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) support from corporate houses to expand this initiative, said a press release.

In the press release, Durga Mohan, Chair - CSR, Rotary Club of Chennai Legends, said "Rotosew is not just about donating sewing machines; it is about enabling women to build sustainable livelihoods with dignity. With the growing demand for tailoring and customised apparel, this skill offers strong opportunities for self-employment and income generation. Beyond training and equipment, we are also working to create market linkages by connecting these women with corporate customers and bulk orders."

Muruganandam M, RI Director (2025-27) and RI Vice President (2026-27) was the Chief Guest and Vinod Saraogi, District Governor (2025-26), was the guest of honour.

A tribute to MS Amma



As part of PS Senior Secondary School's Golden Jubilee celebration, a two-hour bio-play on Bharat Ratna MS Subbulakshmi was staged at Narada Gana Sabha.

Presidency College's seminar on Family System

The Post Graduate and Research Department of Public Administration at Presidency College organised a three-day national level workshop from March 5. The Indian Council For Social Science Research - SRC sponsored event titled "The Role of Social Institutions in Strengthening the Family System," brought together academic experts and policy practitioners to discuss the evolving social fabric of India. Krishna Swamy, former Member Secretary of the Tamil Nadu State Higher Education Council, discussed the transformative

role of educational institutions.

Akila Ayyappan, Medical Officer at Greater Chennai Corporation, shared insights into preventive healthcare techniques and their long-term importance in maintaining family health. A significant portion of the session was dedicated to the importance of "Legal Literacy" for family members. Knowing one's rights regarding inheritance, domestic protection, and social benefits is essential for maintaining a resilient family system, said the release.

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ProNutramax introduces two brands

ProNutramax, a health drink company, has launched two brands: 'Pro Nutra Kidz' for the mind and body, and 'Authentic Natural Indian (ANI)', aimed at preserving traditional Indian cooking.

Pro Nutra Kidz comes in two flavours: classic vanilla and rich chocolate, designed to support strong bones, boost immunity and provide sustained energy.

ANI offers a variety of spices and instant mixes, including 'idli podi,' 'rasam,' 'sambar,' 'puliyotharai,' and 'rava idli' mixes.

Latha Dubay, founder of ProNutramax,

in a release said, "Today's new-generation parents often find it hard to balance their kids' hectic school schedules with proper nutrition, while also trying to keep the authentic flavours of traditional home cooking.

Understanding this, ProNutramax has combined science-backed nutrition with the trusted taste of the past to bring back parent-approved nutrition to every family's table, said the release. For details, contact 95009 10040 98402 97720. Website : <https://pronutramax.com/>

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Recognising the Unrecognised

The third edition of Rotary Club of Madras Metro's Spirit of India Awards honoured four individuals from four cities

The Rotary Club of Madras Metro presented the 3rd Edition of the Spirit of India Awards 2026, a pan-India initiative dedicated to "Recognising the Unrecognised" – individuals who have made extraordinary contributions to society, often away from the public spotlight, on March 13 at Madras Management Association.

The event was graced by T. M.



The awardees seen with Veeraraghav, Executive Editor, NDTV (3rd from left); Dr. Vijaya Bharathi Rangarajan (3rd from right); Club President Mahesh Krishna (2nd from right); Club Secretary Binny Rajkumar (extreme right); Suresh Jain (2nd from left) and Ram Kumar P T (extreme left)

Veeraraghav, Executive Editor, NDTV, as the chief guest, and Rtn. Dr. Vijaya Bharathi Rangarajan, District Governor Elect, 2027 - 28 as the guest of honour.

The winners are: Chandana Sinha, Inspector, RPF (Guardian

of Hope), Lucknow, for her exemplary service in protecting vulnerable children and ensuring safety and dignity within the railway ecosystem; Jagriti Mishra, animal activist from Delhi, recognised for her relentless de-

dication to animal welfare and advocacy for the protection and humane treatment of animals; P. Naveen Kumar, Champion of Dignity from Erode, was acknowledged for his inspiring work in empowering communi-

ties and upholding human dignity through social initiatives; and Dr. Suneela Kumar Hebba - Healing Beyond Boundaries, Bengaluru, for his compassionate medical service and commitment to providing healthcare that reaches beyond conventional limits.

The Spirit of India Awards initiative by the Rotary Club of Madras Metro aims to spotlight unsung heroes across India whose courage, compassion, and commitment make a meaningful difference in society, said a release.

Through this platform, the club continues its mission of promoting humanitarian values and encouraging individuals who work tirelessly for the welfare of others without seeking recognition.

The president of the club A. S. Mahesh Krishna expressed that these awards serve as a reminder that true heroes often work silently, driven only by the spirit of service and humanity.

'Super Chennai Manifesto 2026' unveiled

Consolidating recommendations from senior bureaucrats, urban planners, industry representatives, sustainability experts and cultural leaders during the Super Chennai Conclave, the manifesto will be formally presented to key policymakers

Super Chennai, a citizen-led city-wide branding movement, has unveiled the Super Chennai Manifesto 2026, a comprehensive civic blueprint titled "Super Chennai Compact: For a Global, Resilient City." The manifesto outlines a structured, data-backed roadmap to position Chennai among the world's most competitive, sustainable and culturally confident cities. Evolving from a city-focused dialogue platform into a structured civic movement, Super Chennai has consolidated recommendations from senior bureaucrats, urban planners, industry representatives, sustainability experts and cultural leaders during the Super Chennai Conclave, along with inputs gathered through citizen outreach programmes. The manifesto will be formally presented to key policymakers and senior bureaucrats, with detailed recommendations submitted as part of a structured engagement process aimed at collaborative implementation, said a press release.

Rather than a one-time declaration, the Manifesto is

designed as a living civic framework that will be pursued through continuous policy engagement, working groups and structured collaboration with government and institutions.

The highlights

- * Launch fully functional and standardised corporation websites, publish ward-level performance dashboards ranking waste, roads, lights and grievance resolution, conduct quarterly public infrastructure audits, and enforce time-bound project delivery with contractor accountability.

- * Adopt single integrated tenders for roads, drains and utilities to end repeated digging, reform FSI norms along transit corridors for vertical mixed-use growth.

- * Integrate MTC buses with Metro, Suburban and MRTS networks, implement AI-enabled traffic optimisation, enforce disciplined bus bays and auto halting.

- * Implement safe routes to school citywide, eliminate exposed mud shoulders, mandate universal accessibility standards in all public and commercial spaces, and

enforce strict anti-encroachment and street discipline.

- * Deploy AI-driven smart monsoon systems, publish a long-term State Water Security Strategy, expand reservoirs and desalination.

- * Mandate 70% green

power for data centres, relocate high-load compute zones away from residential areas, anchor future industrial corridors in renewable energy, and enforce strong technical standards for large developments.

- * Operationalise a state-backed fund-of-funds mandating local startup investment, focus on advanced manufacturing, robotics and space-tech, position "Chennai.ai" as Chennai's global tech identity, and encourage equity-participation models in leading colleges.

- * Deploy dedicated equity funds for SC/ST, transgender

and differently-abled entrepreneurs, establish Women Entrepreneurship Hubs, create safe co-working spaces along transit corridors,

and scale AI and leadership training for MSMEs.

- * Train thousands of taxi and auto drivers as city ambassadors.

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